

OUTLIERS

Memory

Layer 1 of 4 · Somewhere to put what you know,
that is still there tomorrow.

Why does it not remember?

You explain your business to it. It understands, it helps, and then you close the window and all of it is gone. Next time you start from nothing and explain it again.

WHAT THE LAST LAYER LEFT YOU WITH

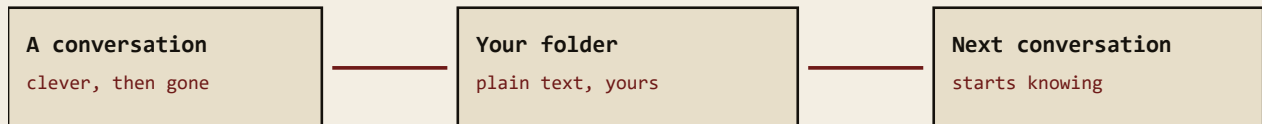
Nothing yet. This is the bottom of the ladder, so it starts with what you have already: what you know about your own business, spread across your head, your inbox, your phone, a folder of documents, and three or four things you pay for monthly that do not talk to each other.

An AI chat window is the same problem in a newer coat. It is clever for as long as the conversation lasts and remembers none of it afterwards.

WHAT THIS LAYER BUILDS

One folder, on your own computer, holding plain text files. Plain text means the words are stored exactly as you would read them, with no special program needed to open them - so what you write today can still be opened in ten years by anything at all.

Then the wiring that makes it a memory rather than a drawer: the folder is pointed at from wherever you start work, so your AI finds it without being told; and a copy of every change is kept, so nothing you write can be lost by a mistake later.



A copy of every change is kept underneath, so nothing is ever only in one p

WHAT CHANGES: THE MIDDLE BOX, WHICH DID NOT EXIST BEFORE

How it works

Three pieces, none of which you have to understand to use.

The folder. An ordinary folder, in an ordinary place on your computer. Everything your system knows lives inside it as text files. You can open any of them yourself, read them, and change them by hand if you want to. Nothing is hidden in a database you cannot see into.

The pointer. A short note written into your AI's own settings saying where that folder is. Without it, your AI only knows about the folder when you happen to be standing in it. With it, you can be anywhere and ask about your own business and it knows where to look.

The copies. A tool called git keeps a copy of every version of every file, forever, on your machine. It is the difference between 'undo that' and 'start again'. It runs underneath and you never have to think about it, which is the only reason it gets used.

I put mine in Documents and called it Second Brain, which is the whole of the naming decision. Where it lives matters far less than that it is somewhere you will not tidy away by accident.

Build it

One command. It asks you a few questions so what you get is yours, then does the work.

```
git clone https://github.com/OUTLIERS-ai/outliers-sb-01-memory
cd outliers-sb-01-memory
python install.py
```

This is the bottom layer, so it needs nothing beneath it. It will not overwrite anything: if there are already files where you point it, it says so and asks before going further.

WHAT IT ASKS YOU, AND WHY

QUESTION	WHAT IT CHANGES
Where should it live?	Creates the folder there and remembers the location. Anywhere permanent will do.
What is your business, in a sentence?	Written into the rulebook, so answers come back about your work rather than in general.
Keep copies of every change?	Sets up git. Saying no leaves you with no way back from a mistake, so the answer is yes unless you already have your own backup.

WHAT YOU END UP WITH

A folder with a small set of empty rooms in it - one for people, one for projects, one for meetings, one for what you have read - a rulebook your AI reads before it does anything, and the wiring that makes both of those findable from anywhere.

It is empty. That is correct. An empty room you own beats a full one you rent.

Using it

You do not learn commands. You talk to it, and it decides where things go.

Tell it what happened, in normal words: what a client said, what you decided and why, what you charged, what you read. It writes that down in the right place without asking you to choose one.

Then ask it something you would otherwise have to remember: what did I quote that person, what did we agree, what have I already tried here. The first time it answers something you never typed in as a question, the folder has stopped being storage.

IF YOU ALREADY HAD SOMETHING LIKE THIS

If you already keep notes in Obsidian, Notion or a folder of documents, you have most of this. The test that proves it: open your AI somewhere else entirely - not inside that folder - and ask it something only your notes would know. If it cannot find them, you have the storage and not the pointer, and this layer installs the pointer without moving anything you have.

WHAT THIS LAYER LEAVES UNSOLVED

A folder will accept anything. It will take a note, a photograph, a spreadsheet, a half-finished thought and a copy of something you already wrote last month, and it will treat all of them the same way.

It also has no idea what a good note looks like. Two notes can end up with the same name and different contents, and when you later ask a question that touches both, you get one of them. Not the right one - just whichever was found first. Nothing tells you that happened.

NEXT: LAYER 2 • STANDARDS

Writing down what a note has to contain and what things are called, in a form software can check, plus something that quietly checks it and tells you when it is no longer true.

WORDS USED IN THIS GUIDE

Vault	The folder your second brain lives in. An ordinary folder; the name is just what Obsidian calls it.
Plain text	Words stored exactly as written, openable by anything, with no program required to read them.
Git	A tool that keeps a copy of every version of every file, on your own machine, so nothing can be permanently lost.
Terminal	A box you type instructions into, which talks to your computer directly instead of through buttons someone designed for you.